Funmilola Abeke Sandra Adetoye

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Nigeria

LAWYER · HIGHER EDUCATION LEADER · RESEARCHER · ADR PROFESSIONAL · LEADERSHIP & LIFE COACH

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Legal professional, higher education leader, researcher and leadership/life coach with over 20 years of progressive experience across legal advisory, institutional governance, academic administration, human resource management, regulatory compliance, dispute resolution and youth development. Holds a PhD in Law, LLM and a Master's in Managerial Psychology. Passionate about strengthening institutions, developing people and helping young adults discover purpose, build leadership capacity and transition successfully into meaningful careers.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Principal Assistant Registrar / Head, Academic Affairs & Legal Adviser

Jun 2019 – Present

CHRISLAND UNIVERSITY, ABEOKUTA, OGUN STATE

- Strategic leadership across academic administration, institutional governance, student affairs, policy and legal/regulatory compliance.
- Coordinate Senate, Council and Management Committee processes — preparation, documentation, minutes and action tracking.
- Provide legal and policy guidance on institutional matters; support NUC compliance and university policy.
- Coordinated NUC accreditation — contributed to approval of new programmes and establishment of the College of Basic Medical Sciences.
- Secretary, Student Disciplinary Committee (7+ years); design career, leadership and employability programmes.
- Develop institutional MoUs with healthcare and educational organisations to expand experiential learning.

Chief Human Resources Officer / Legal Adviser

Mar 2006 – Jun 2021

NATIONAL HORTICULTURAL RESEARCH INSTITUTE (NIHORT), IBADAN

- Established the Institute's Legal Unit as pioneer Legal Adviser — legal opinions, contract review and compliance.
- Led appointment, promotion and discipline under public-service regulations.
- Administered pension scheme with 100% regulatory compliance and zero penalties throughout tenure.
- Reviewed procurement policies and practices; contributed to Public Procurement Act compliance.
- Mentored staff; initiated cooperative savings scheme operational for 5+ years with external audit.

Legal Officer (National Youth Service Corps)

Oct 2003 – Sep 2004

MINISTRY OF JUSTICE, ABAKALIKI, EBONYI STATE

- Supported legal and administrative functions in a public-sector justice environment.

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

- Legal & Regulatory Affairs
- Higher Education Governance
- Academic Administration
- Alternative Dispute Resolution
- Legal Research & Policy
- Institutional Compliance
- Human Resource Management
- Leadership Development
- Career Development & Employability
- Youth Development & Mentoring
- Programme Management
- AI-Assisted Research

RESEARCH, SCHOLARSHIP & PUBLICATIONS

Research interests: Alternative Dispute Resolution, marital disputes, digital privacy, indigenous families, surrogacy and reproductive technology, intellectual property, gender and constitutionalism, and Nigerian legal and policy issues.

DOCTORAL RESEARCH — *Alternative Dispute Resolution in Marital Disputes in Lagos State: An Appraisal.*
PhD Thesis — Babcock University, 2025

PUBLICATION — *A New Wing for Mediation in Nigeria: Assessing the Impact of the Arbitration and Mediation Act, 2023.*

PUBLICATION — *Evaluating the Legal Framework for Alternative Dispute Resolution in the Resolution of Marital Disputes in Nigeria.*

PUBLICATION — *Indigenous Families in Nigeria — The Dilemma of Invasion of Privacy in the Era of Digital Technology.*

PUBLICATION — *Surrogacy in Nigeria: Prospects, Ethical and Legal Considerations.*

EMPIRICAL STUDY — *Beyond the Courtroom: An Empirical Assessment of Mediation in Marital Disputes in Lagos State, Nigeria.*

EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy (PhD / LLD) Babcock University — 2025

Master of Laws (LLM) University of Ibadan — 2015

Master of Managerial Psychology (MMP) University of Ibadan — 2010

Barrister-at-Law (BL) Nigerian Law School — 2003

Bachelor of Laws (LLB Hons.) Ogun State University — 2002

LEADERSHIP, COACHING & YOUTH DEVELOPMENT

2019 - Present — **Certified Life Coach** LIFE MASTERY ACADEMY
Mentors and equips young adults through structured programmes: identity, purpose, leadership, emotional intelligence, financial literacy and personal growth.

2019 - Present — **Youth Leadership & Entrepreneurship Coordinator** JUBILEE HOUSE
Coordinates youth programmes, freshers' programmes, entrepreneurship initiatives and leadership-development activities.

2021 - Present — **Mentor** THE VOICE INCORPORATED
Mentors young adults in purpose discovery, career development, self-management and leadership.

2022 — **Curriculum Development** THE VOICE IESSP LIFE COACH PROGRAMME
Co-developed mentoring and discipleship curriculum in active organisational use.

2013 - 2019 — **Teen Church Leader** HARVEST HOUSE
Designed leadership programmes, career-awareness sessions and life-skills activities for teenagers.

SPEAKING & FACILITATION

- Leadership Development
- Career Planning & Employability
- Purpose Discovery
- Emotional Intelligence
- Professional Ethics
- Personal Effectiveness
- Financial Intelligence
- Career Readiness
- Entrepreneurship
- Youth Development
- Life Mastery

AI, DIGITAL & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

2024 — **Certificate of Achievement in AI — Distinction**
VICBHE/NUC in partnership with NOUN
13-week practical training in AI for Teaching, Research and Community Service.

Sep 2026 — **28-Day AI Challenge — Certificate of Completion**
SuccessWise.ai

Generative AI: ChatGPT, Microsoft Copilot, Claude — research, professional writing, information synthesis and productivity.

Digital tools: Microsoft Word, Excel, PowerPoint; Learning Management Systems; Zoom, Microsoft Teams, Google Meet.

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

- Nigerian Bar Association (NBA)
- Institute of Chartered Mediators and Conciliators
- Association of Ranking Professionals
- Institute of Chartered Secretaries & Administrators (UK)
- Chartered Institute of Administration (ACIA)
- Association of Cybersecurity Practitioners

SELECTED CONFERENCES & PROFESSIONAL TRAINING

Mar 2026	Professional Mediation Skills Training	Institute of Mediators and Conciliators
Jun 2026	Conference of the Canadian Association of African Studies	
Feb 2026	Veritas SDG Conference	
Sep 2023	IUS Summer School of International Arbitration	International University of Sarajevo
Oct-Nov 2022	NBA/WARCLARS Continuing Legal Education	University of Lagos
2019	Conference of Education Professionals	Institute of Public Administration of Nigeria

SELECTED PROFESSIONAL IMPACT

20+	1,800+	250–300	100%
YEARS OF PRACTICE	STUDENTS SUPPORTED	COACHED ANNUALLY	PENSION COMPLIANCE

- Mentored and supported a university community of over 1,800 students; directly coached 250–300 young adults annually through structured development programmes.
- Contributed to NUC accreditation — approval of new academic programmes and establishment of the College of Basic Medical Sciences.
- Established NIHORT's Legal Unit from inception and strengthened legal, governance and compliance processes institute-wide.
- Maintained 100% pension regulatory compliance without penalties or sanctions across full tenure at NIHORT.
- Developed institutional MoUs with healthcare and educational organisations to expand student experiential learning.